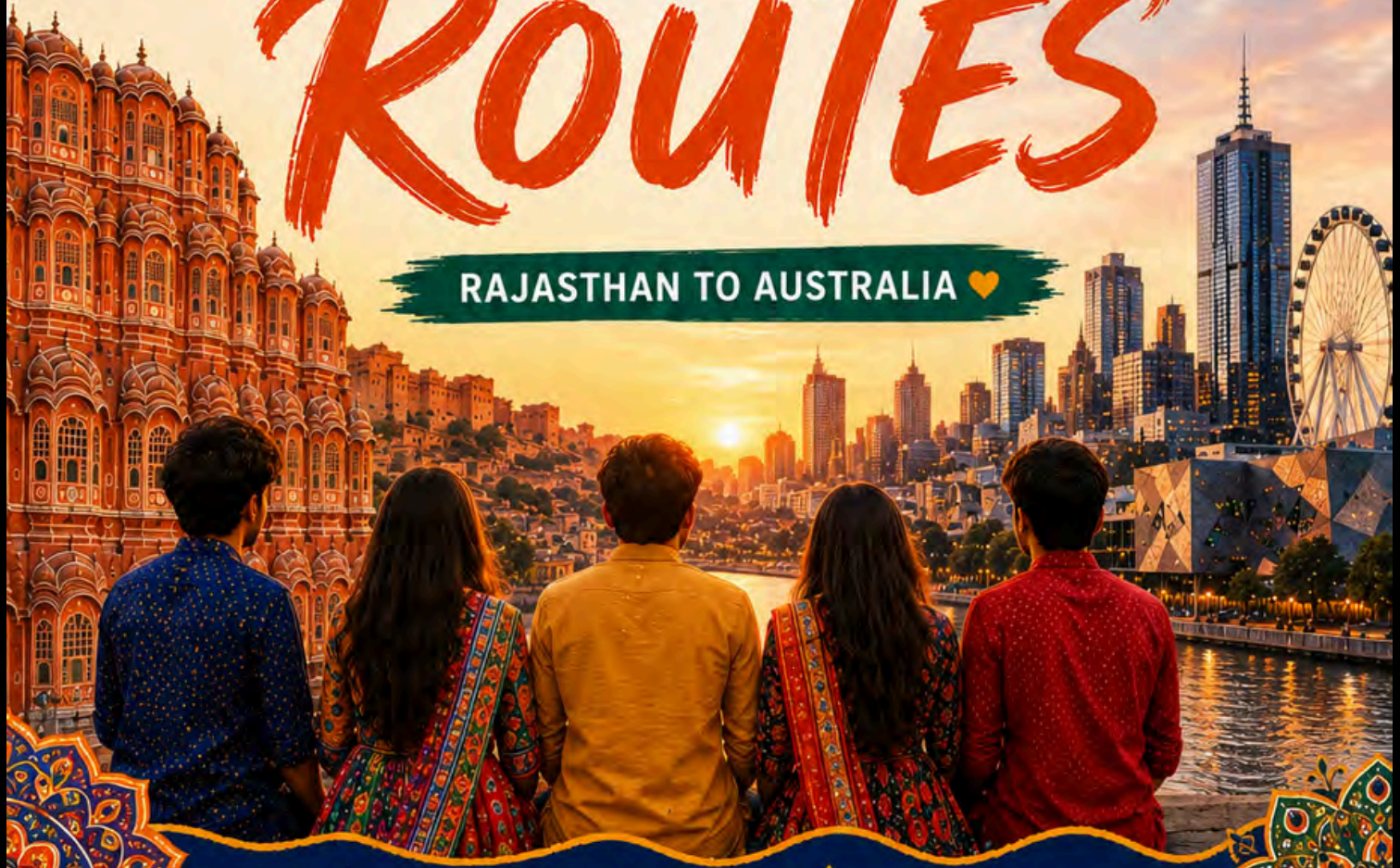
YOUTH & COMMUNITY NEWSLETTER

2026–27

RAJKOV ROOTS & ROUTES

RAJASTHAN TO AUSTRALIA



OUR HERITAGE | OUR COMMUNITY | OUR FUTURE | OUR PRIDE

2026–27 Edition



Celebrating Rajasthan • Growing Together in Australia

ROOTS & ROUTES

What does being Rajasthani mean when you've grown up in Australia?

Stories • Culture • Festivals • Music • Careers • Community

A celebration of Rajasthani heritage, identity, and community life across Australia. From vibrant festivals to career journeys, this is your space.





RAJKOV Youth & Community Newsletter

Join us as we explore what it means to carry Rajasthan in our hearts while building our futures on Australian soil.

Connecting young Rajasthani Australians through culture, creativity, and community spirit across generations.

Issue #2

Media Partner & Sponsors Partners

गणगौर TELEVISION

EST. 2003

RAJASTHANI KUTUMB OF VICTORIA

पधारो म्हारे देस ।

KHAMMA GHANI
RAJKOV PARIVAR

We are delighted to share a proud milestone with our RAJKOV community.
Through the collective efforts of our committee, we have successfully
secured sponsorship support from our generous sponsors:

★★★ PLATINUM SPONSOR ★★★

CYP FOODS & SPICES

CYP
Chirag ji & Yogesh ji

★★★ GOLD SPONSOR ★★★

NEXUS DEVELOPMENT
Bhupendra ji & Nupur ji

★★ SILVER SPONSORS ★★

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RADEVO LIVING
BUILT - TRANSFORM - ELEVATE
Dilip ji & Richa ji
(Radevo Living)

★★★ BRONZE SPONSORS ★★★

VenkateshG
Individual

AUSSIE LOANS
Nikita ji
(Aussie Loans)

KESARIA MARKETING
Vishal ji
(USA)

A heartfelt thank you to all our sponsors for their trust,
generosity, and support towards RAJKOV.
We warmly invite more businesses, professionals, and well-wishers to join hands
in strengthening our community.

President's Message

खम्मा घणी सा, राम राम सा, म्हारा राजकोव रतन कुटुम्ब!
It is my honour and privilege to welcome you all to RAJKOV Teej Utsav 2026, a celebration of our culture, traditions and togetherness.

I respectfully acknowledge the Traditional Custodians of this land, pay my respects to their Elders, and thank Australia for giving us the opportunity to live, grow and proudly celebrate our heritage.

My heartfelt gratitude to our Founder Members, Past Presidents, Committees and Volunteers, whose vision and selfless contribution have built the strong Rajkov family we cherish today.
थां बिना आज रो राजकोव संभव कोनी होतो।

This year, we are especially honoured to welcome
Dr. Santosh Kumar OAM, a distinguished academic originally from Kota and recipient of the Medal of the Order of Australia for his contribution to the Indian community, and

Mr. Arun Sharma, Co-Founder of Celebrate India, whose leadership has helped showcase Indian culture through Melbourne's iconic Diwali celebrations at Federation Square.

Teej Utsav brings together everything Rajkov stands for—our women, youth, children, elders, culture and community. From our little ones and cultural performers to the RAJKOV Band, folk traditions, Kathputli, Kids Corner and authentic Rajasthani food, tonight is about experiencing a little Rajasthan right here in Melbourne.

My sincere thanks to our Executive Committee their Fanilies, Youth Committee, sponsors, performers, volunteers and every participating family for making this celebration possible.

As we always say:
"राजकोव कोई संस्था मात्र कोनी... ई तो म्हारो कुटुम्ब है।"
Rajkov is not just an organisation—it is our family.
Together, let us preserve our roots, empower our youth and women, respect our elders, and proudly carry our Rajasthani heritage into the next generation.
पधारो सा... आप सब रो Teej Utsav 2026 में दिल सूं हार्दिक स्वागत है।

आपरी सेवा में,
Vishal Gupta

Message from Shri V. Srinivas Ji (IAS, CS, Govt of Rajasthan)



हरियाली Teej Parv के विशेष कार्यक्रम पर Pravasi कुटुम्ब ऑफ विक्टोरिया एवं सभी प्रवासी राजस्थानियों को Rajasthan राज्य सरकार की ओर से बधाई। अत्यंत हर्ष का विषय है कि आप सभी हजारों किलोमीटर दूर से राजस्थान की संस्कृति, लोक संगीत, खान-पान और परंपराओं को पूरे उत्साह के साथ जीवित बनाए हुए हैं। I wish all the organizers and प्रवासी राजस्थानियों my very best wishes on this auspicious occasion of Teej celebration. जय, जय राजस्थान.

Community calendar

RAJKOV
Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria
SINCE 2003

2026-27 Annual Calendar

Celebrating Our Heritage. Strengthening Our Community.

1	2	3	4	5
18TH JULY 2026	29TH AUGUST 2026	EARLY NOV 2026	MID FEB 2027	END MARCH 2027
				
CHAUPAL & DARBAR	TEEJ MAHOTSAV	DIWALI MAHOTSAV	CHAUPAL & DARBAR	GANGAUR MAHOTSAV
Community Gathering	*Major Cultural Festival*	*Community Celebration*	*Community Gathering*	*Major Cultural Festival*
100 – 120 PEOPLE	300 – 350 PEOPLE	150 – 200 PEOPLE	100 – 120 PEOPLE	300 – 350 PEOPLE

EVENT CLASSIFICATION

MAJOR CULTURAL FESTIVALS
Teej Mahotsav • Gangaur Mahotsav

COMMUNITY EVENTS
Chaupal & Darbar • Diwali Mahotsav

Let's celebrate our roots, create memories and build a stronger community!

DATES ARE TENTATIVE
Subject to change.

ATTENDANCE IS APPROXIMATE
May vary depending on the event.

MORE DETAILS SOON!
Venues, timings & registrations will be communicated in advance.

About RAJKOV

More Than a community. More Than Festivals.
RAJKOV (Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria) is where culture, family and belonging come together.

We unite Rajasthani families to celebrate our traditions, build lifelong friendships and inspire the next generation of leaders. Whether your roots are in Rajasthan or Australia, RAJKOV welcomes everyone with the warmth of family.

From vibrant cultural festivals and family gatherings to youth leadership, community service and professional networking, we create opportunities to connect, grow and give back. Proud of our heritage and inspired by Australia's multicultural spirit, we are preserving our traditions while building a stronger future together.
Our roots unite us. Our values inspire us. Our future belongs to all of us.







A Message from Our Founding Families

In 2003, far from our homeland but united by our shared Rajasthani roots, six families came together with a simple dream—to create a home away from home for Rajasthanis in Victoria.

What began as informal gatherings to celebrate our festivals, speak our language, and support one another soon grew into RAJKOV – Rajasthani Kutumb of Victoria. The vision was never just to organise events, but to build a family where every Rajasthani would feel welcomed, connected, and proud of their heritage while embracing life in Australia.

We gratefully acknowledge our founding families, whose vision laid the foundation for the vibrant community we enjoy today:

- Ghanshyam & Savita Soni
- Brij & Vandana Panwar
- Mahendra & Sunita Goyal
- Rajesh & Sunita Manihar
- Rajiv & Anjul Sharma
- The Jawle Family, who contributed during the early days before relocating to the United States.

Today, more than two decades later, RAJKOV continues to grow because of their foresight, commitment and belief that our culture, traditions and values are strongest when shared as one family. We honour their legacy and remain committed to carrying that vision forward for generations to come.

Founder’s Stories

Brij Panwar co-founded RAJKOV in 2003 with five other families to preserve Rajasthani culture, connect future generations to their roots, and build a supportive community in Australia. As RAJKOV’s first Secretary, and later Vice President and President, he laid the foundation for the organisation’s growth. His home remains RAJKOV’s registered address, and his continued mentorship, guidance and service as Returning Officer have helped shape the inclusive and vibrant community RAJKOV is today.



Founder’s Stories

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culture and traditions for future generations in Australia.
Mahendra Ji dedicated nearly 26 years as an Accounting Lecturer at Monash University, while Sunita Ji has been the pillar of their family. Together, they have remained committed to fostering a strong, connected Rajasthani community where festivals, traditions and values continue to thrive. Their dedication has helped shape RAJKOV into the vibrant and welcoming family it is today



Ex-President’s Chapter-Surya Soni and Madhuri ji

Surya and Madhuri remain deeply grateful to RAJKOV and the wider Indian diaspora for the warmth and support that helped them settle into life here in Australia. That gratitude has shaped a lasting commitment to giving back to the community.

Surya’s connection with RAJKOV began in 2005, when he first arrived in Australia as an international student. He later became a Life Member upon his marriage, and soon stepped into a leadership role as Secretary of the RAJKOV Executive Committee in 2009–10. His dedication grew from there: he went on to serve as RAJKOV President in 2013–14, and held the offices of Secretary, Vice President, President, and Trustee with the Federation of Indian Associations of Victoria Inc.

Now largely retired from formal community leadership, Surya continues to contribute through VICHAR, a webinar series he runs to bring together diverse voices from across the community and provide a platform for their thought leadership.

Surya and Madhuri’s journey is a wonderful reminder of how generosity and service can strengthen the bonds that hold our community together.



Committee Corner



Vishal Gupta

Role : President
Fav festival: Diwali, Holi
Fun fact : I portrayed king Ashok role in class 12th



Rahuk Jain

Role : Vice President
Fav festival: Gangaur
Fun fact : I love meeting friends



Akshat Soni

Role : Scretary
Fav festival: Diwali, Holi
Fact Files: If nothing else, you'd find me solving the rubiks cube.



Ritu Singh

Role : Treasurer
Fav festival: Teej
Fun fact : I was selected in SSB army cadet but didnt proceed



Bhoomija

Role : Committee Member
Fav festival: Teej
Fun fact : I started roller skating when I was 4

Commitee Initiatives

Hello Everyone,

This year, the RAJKOV Committee has taken a proactive approach to strengthen our community by launching the Youth Committee and RAJKOV Youth Band to empower the next generation. We introduced a pre-planned annual calendar with early venue bookings, making it easier for families to plan and ensuring well-organised events. Membership has been enhanced with Unique Annual & Life Member Family IDs and an Early Bird RAJKOV Coin initiative to encourage timely renewals. We have also started early engagement with sponsors and are actively pursuing government grants and council funding opportunities to support community programs and ensure the long-term sustainability of RAJKOV. Together, these initiatives are helping build a stronger, more connected, and future-ready community.

Kutumb initiative

RAJKOV
UNITY • CULTURE • HERITAGE

INTRODUCING
MARU REWARDS
KUTUMB COINS

Your participation. Our strength.
Your rewards. Our appreciation.

★ PARTICIPATE • CONTRIBUTE • GET REWARDED! ★

EARN KUTUMB COINS

Renewal Within Due Date	20
Upgrade to Life Membership	100
Refer a New Family (after they become members)	50
Volunteer at Rajkov Events	20
Perform in Cultural Programs	20
Join Youth Committee / Newsletter Team	20
Attend Rajkov Darbar / Chaupal Events	20

Coins are awarded to your Membership Family based on your participation and contribution.

REDEEM YOUR COINS

350 COINS	= $5 DISCOUNT
500 COINS	= $10 DISCOUNT
750 COINS	= $15 DISCOUNT

HOW REDEMPTION WORKS

- Coins are combined under your Membership Number.
- Use your Coins on the total cost of any ONE ticket purchase (booking) under that Membership Number.
- Discount applies to the total booking amount, not to individual tickets or individual family members.
- Maximum one reward redemption per event.
- Coins are non-transferable and cannot be exchanged for cash.

★ RAJKOV CHAMPIONS RECOGNITION ★

Top contributors will be recognised at our major events with:

1. RAJKOV CHAMPION AWARD
2. COMMUNITY SERVICE RECOGNITION
3. YOUTH CHAMPION AWARD
- SPECIAL CERTIFICATES & ON-STAGE RECOGNITION

HOW IT WORKS

1. Participate & Contribute — Take part in eligible activities.
2. Earn Kutumb Coins — Coins are added to your Membership Family balance.
3. Redeem & Enjoy — Use your Coins for discount on event tickets at major Rajkov events.

IMPORTANT GUIDELINES

- Coins are awarded per Membership Family.
- Referral Coins are credited only after the referred family completes membership.
- The Committee reserves the right to verify all claims.
- Coin balances will be maintained by Rajkov and shared periodically.

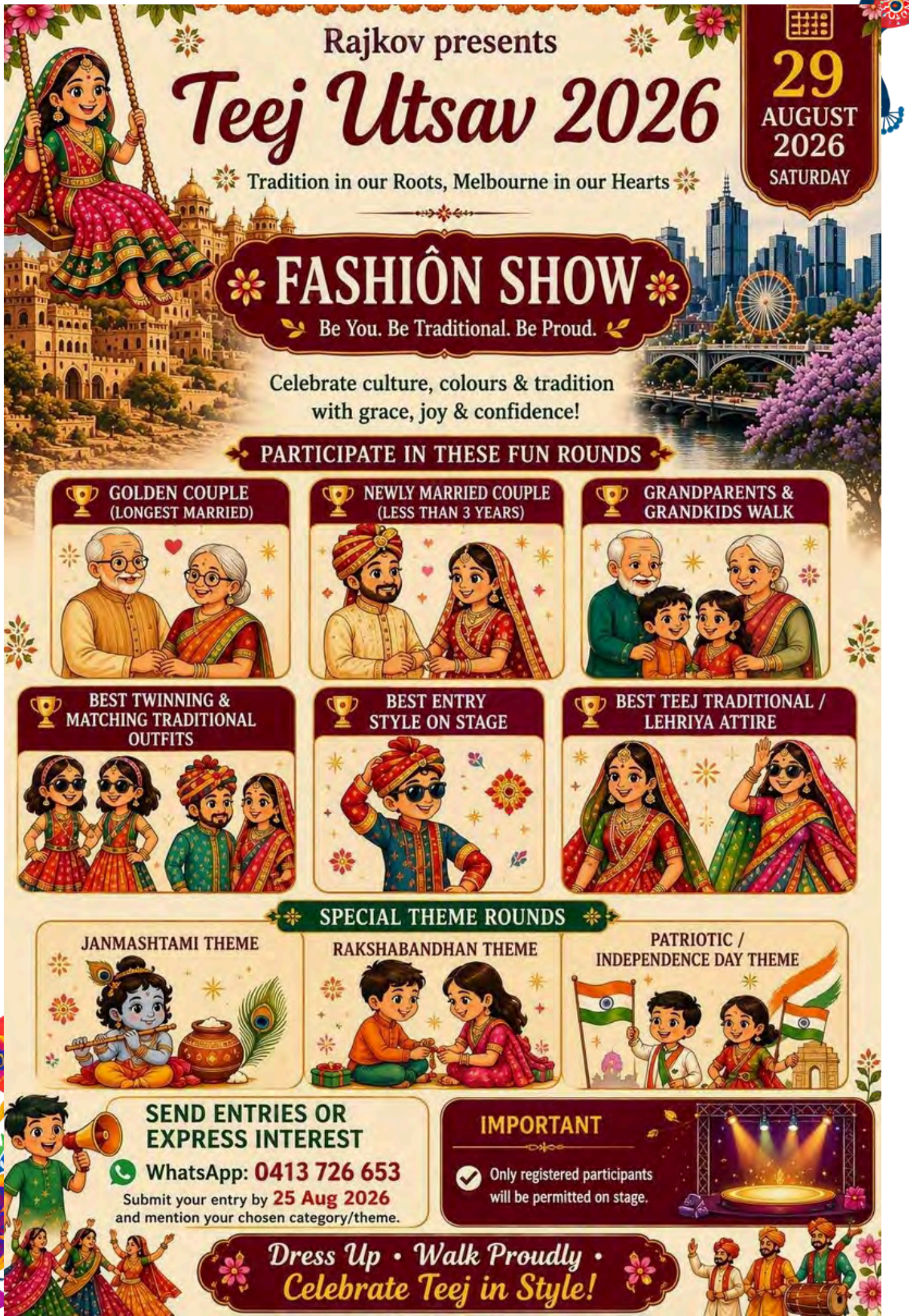
ONE FAMILY • ONE MEMBERSHIP
ONE COIN BALANCE • SHARED REWARDS

MORE PARTICIPATION. MORE CONNECTIONS. MORE REWARDS.

Kutumb initiative



Kutumb initiative



Community Corner & Volunteer Opportunity

Hello Everyone,

I hope this message finds you well! I wanted to take a moment to discuss something that is very dear to me—our wonderful heritage and its significance for our future here in Australia. Our parents traveled all the way from Rajasthan, carrying with them a wealth of traditions and a vibrant culture. Now, it's our opportunity to carry that legacy forward and define what Rajasthani culture will look like for the next generation.

- It doesn't matter if you're fluent in Marwari or just know a few phrases.
- Whether you've visited Jaipur countless times or haven't had the chance yet—this community is for everyone.

Each of us contributes a unique piece to the puzzle, and that's what makes our community truly special. This newsletter is your platform to connect, share, and celebrate our rich heritage. Let's continue to build something wonderful together!

Youth Committee Corner



- Bhoomija
- Prassidhi Kothari
- Akshat Soni
- Yogit Chaudhary
- Aarna Tripathi
- Arjun Agarwal
- Avantika Gupta
- Bani Sodha
- Ira Singh
- Malika Chaudhary
- Reeya Khanduri
- Sanemi Jajoo
- Shaunik Sharma
- Soaham Chauhan
- Trisha Jain
- Veer Chauhan

Star Youths Spotlight-Aug 2026



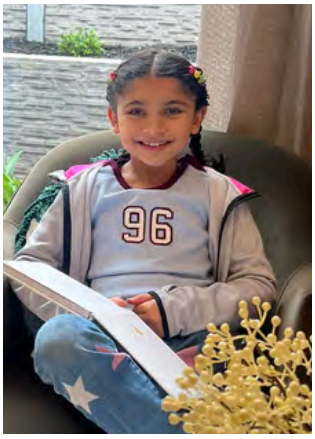
Uchit : He is 12 years old and is very passionate about swimming. He has won a number of prizes in various inter school swimming competition.



Preksha. She is 9 years old and very passionate about sports. She came first place in athletics and achieving greater heights in gymnastics and swimming.



UTrisha Mehta - attended Amplify – Next Glen Events program to develop skills in leadership, event management, teamwork and community engagement, demonstrating confidence, creativity and maturity.





Tia Mehta - She is passionate about Arts & Craft and Made Rakhi





Inaaya Sancheti
7 yrs - She is doing a bollywood dance for last 2 years & has performed in group annual events as lead dancer.





Avantika Gupta - She loves Art, Music , Fluent in German and French Languages

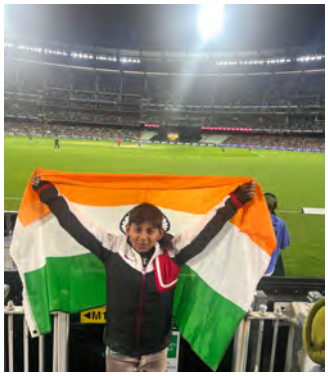
Star Youths Spotlight-Aug 2026



Anvita Mantari has a wonderful passion for creating beautiful handmade bead creations. What started as a creative hobby has grown into something she truly enjoys, allowing her to express her imagination, patience and artistic talent through every piece she makes.



Aryan Sharma, He is Corporal and Flight Commander of Bravo Flight in the Australian Air Force Cadets (AAFC).
"Fortune Favours the Bold" has encouraged him to keep striving for success



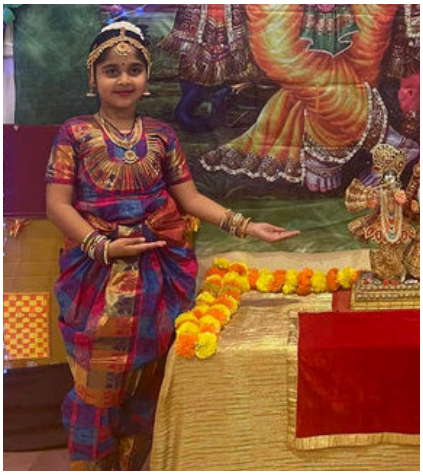
Aarush Jain. He stood second on the inter school table tennis competition recently and also stood third on the discuss throw.



Aarv Jain
He commenced his soccer club journey from this year as 8 was minimum age requirement...
They're playing Victorian club soccer competitions



Vihaan Singh (6 years) has an exceptional talent for numbers, confidently recalling times tables up to 20, solving advanced mental maths problems, and naming the complete Periodic Table with element symbols and atomic numbers. His amazing memory and curiosity for countries, capitals and flags make him a true young knowledge whiz.



Kavisha – A passionate and talented dancer who creates her own choreography and has performed at numerous Rajkov events, school functions, and cultural programs across Australia and India



Praj Jain (11 years) has been learning tabla for the past five years and achieved a Distinction through his dedication and love for music. He has performed at community events, including Melbourne Shwetambar Jain Sangh (MSJS) programs, showcasing his talent and growing confidence on stage.



Ruth (11 years) wrote the inspiring speech "One Heart. One Australia", which was quoted in the Australian House of Representatives and recorded in the official Hansard on 1 July 2026. As a Student Voice Captain and Goldstein Medal recipient, she exemplifies leadership, inclusion and community spirit.

Ziva (5 years) enjoys expressing her creativity through art and recently completed a beautiful acrylic painting during a school holiday art class.



Rajasthan Heritage Spotlight

RAJASTHAN

A land of vibrant culture, rich heritage and timeless creativity.
Rajasthan's traditional arts reflect its history, traditions and the spirit of its people.

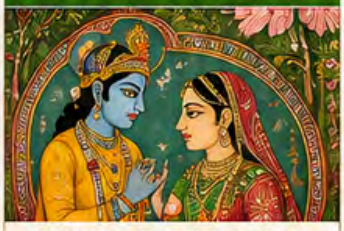
1. PHAD PAINTING



Traditional scroll paintings that depict stories of folk deities and heroes. Used by Bhopas while narrating legends through song.

Shahpura, Bhilwara

2. MINIATURE PAINTING



Intricate and detailed paintings known for fine brushwork, beautiful colours and royal scenes, nature and mythology.

Kishangarh, Mewar, Bundi, Jaipur

3. BLUE POTTERY



Unique pottery made of quartz, glass, multani mitti and natural dyes. Known for its blue and white beauty.

Jaipur

4. THEWA ART



Exquisite art of fusing thin 24K gold onto coloured glass to create elegant jewellery and decorative pieces.

Pratapgarh

5. BANDHANI



Traditional tie-and-dye art known for beautiful dotted patterns. Symbol of color, festivity and tradition.

Jaipur, Jodhpur & Western Rajasthan

6. LEHERIYA



The wave-like tie-dye patterns represent the monsoon, joy and celebration.

Jaipur

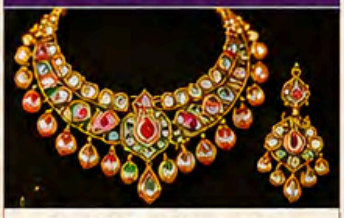
7. BLOCK PRINTING



Hand-carved wooden blocks used to print beautiful patterns on fabric. A fine example of sustainable craftsmanship.

Bagru & Sanganer

8. KUNDAN & MEENAKARI



Exquisite jewellery art that combines gemstnoe setting (Kundan) with colourful enamel work (Meenakari).

Jaipur

9. KATHPUTLI (PUPPETRY)



Traditional string puppets that bring folk tales, humor and social messages to life through storytelling.

Across Rajasthan

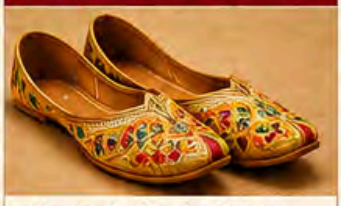
10. MANDANA ART



Traditional floor and wall art made with natural colours and motifs inspired by nature, auspicious symbols and daily life.

Rural Rajasthan

11. MOJARI / JUTTI



Handcrafted leather footwear with intricate embroidery and beautiful designs.

Jaipur, Jodhpur

12. GOTA PATTI



Traditional embroidery using gold and silver ribbons on fabrics, perfect for festive attire.

Jaipur

13. LEATHER & CAMEL CRAFT



Beautiful leather products, bags, lamps and camel hide crafts showcasing rustic creativity.

Jaisalmer, Bikaner

14. GHOOMAR DANCE



Graceful folk dance performed in colorful attire, celebrating tradition, togetherness and joy.

Especially Mewar

15. MAAND (FOLK MUSIC)



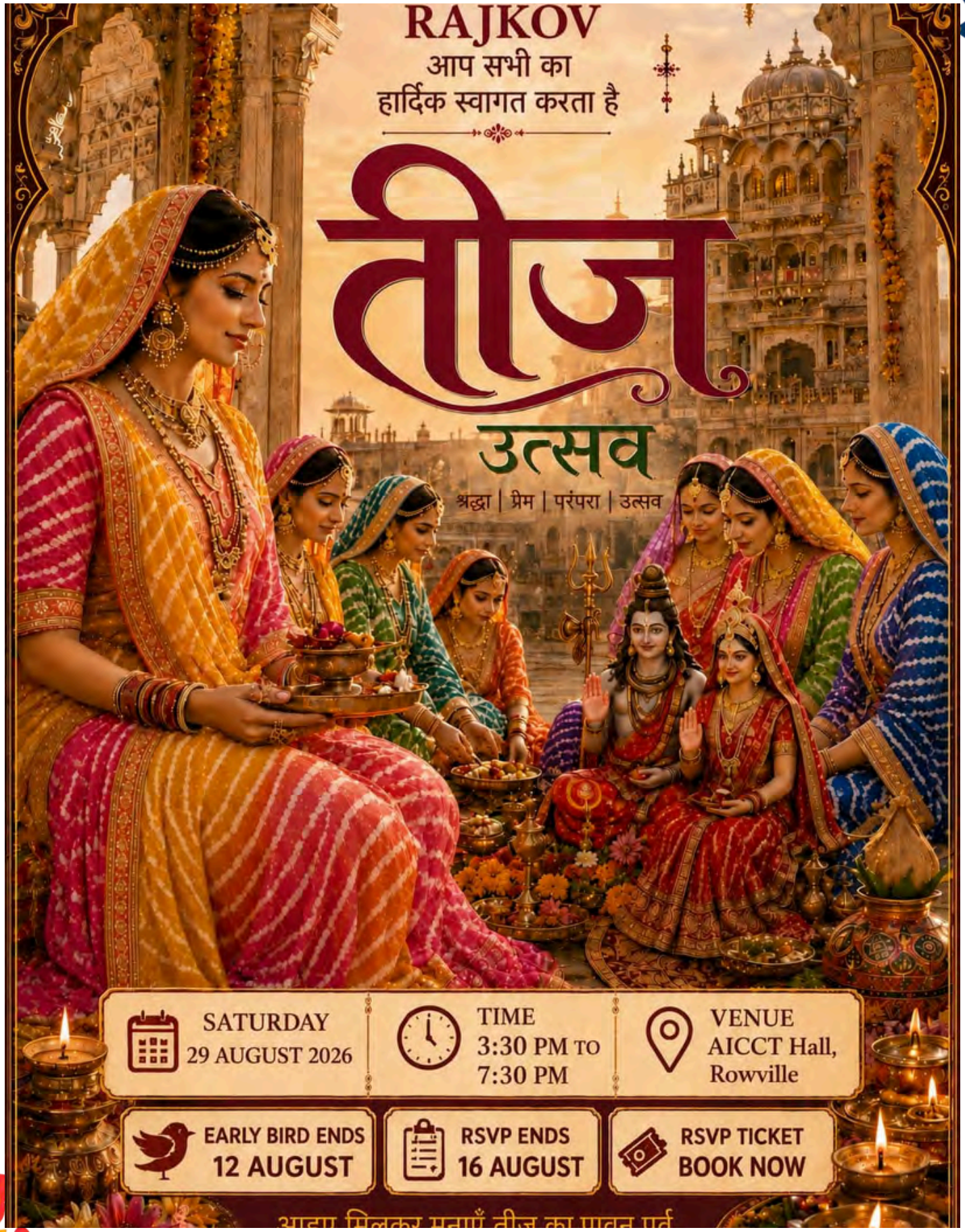
A classical-influenced folk music style known for its soulful melodies and poetic expressions.

Across Rajasthan

Rajasthan's arts are not just crafts, they are stories, traditions and a proud legacy passed down through generations.

पधारो म्हारे देस – कला, संस्कृति और विरासत को संजोए रखें !

Rajasthan Heritage Spotlight-Teej



Rajasthan Heritage Spotlight-Teej

Teej – A Celebration of Tradition, Devotion & Togetherness

Teej is one of Rajasthan's most colourful and cherished festivals, celebrating tradition, devotion, family bonds and the arrival of the monsoon. The festival transforms the rainy season into a joyful celebration filled with greenery, music, colourful attire and community gatherings.

History & Significance

Teej is deeply associated with Goddess Parvati and Lord Shiva. According to Hindu tradition, Goddess Parvati's devotion and perseverance ultimately led to her union with Lord Shiva. The festival therefore symbolises love, commitment, strength and marital harmony.

In Rajasthan, Hariyali Teej has particular cultural significance. The arrival of the monsoon after the intense summer heat represents renewal, prosperity and new beginnings.

Teej in Rajasthan

Women traditionally dress in beautiful Leheriya and Bandhani sarees and poshaks, adorn themselves with jewellery, mehendi and colourful bangles, and come together to sing traditional Teej and Saawan songs.

Decorated swings (jhoolas), folk music and dance create the distinctive festive atmosphere. In Jaipur, the traditional Teej Mata procession has long been one of the festival's most recognisable celebrations, showcasing Rajasthan's royal and cultural heritage.

Food, Family & Festivities

Teej celebrations are also known for festive delicacies such as Ghevar, Feeni and traditional Rajasthani dishes. Families visit one another, exchange sweets and gifts, and celebrate with music, dance and community activities.

From Rajasthan to Melbourne

For Rajasthanis living overseas, Teej has an even deeper meaning. It provides an opportunity to introduce our children and youth to the traditions, music, attire, food and values of Rajasthan, while bringing generations together.

Through RAJKOV Teej Utsav 2026, we celebrate not only a festival, but also the heritage that connects us to our roots.

राजस्थान सूं मेलबर्न तक — संस्कृति, परंपरा अर परिवार रो उत्सव।

Event Highlights-Teej

RAJKOV Teej Utsav 2026 – Event Highlights

A Celebration of Culture, Tradition & Togetherness

RAJKOV's Teej Utsav 2026 brings the colours, traditions, music and festive spirit of Rajasthan to Melbourne—bringing together children, youth, adults and elders in one vibrant celebration.

Traditional Welcome & Cultural Performances

The celebrations feature a Traditional Welcome Ceremony, Welcome Toli by our Little Ones, Ganesh Vandana, children and adult performances, Rajasthani folk dances, Teej & Janmashtami specials, patriotic performances and an exciting Teej Fashion Show.

Kathputli – Rajasthan's Folk Heritage

A special Kathputli Puppet Dance brings one of Rajasthan's most iconic storytelling traditions alive for the next generation.

RAJKOV Band – Live Entertainment

Our very own RAJKOV Band fills the evening with music, energy and melodies celebrating Rajasthan and India.

Kids Corner

Our young Kutumbjan can enjoy Block Painting, Shell Painting, interactive games and creative activities throughout the celebration.

Rajasthani Food & Hospitality

A delicious spread of traditional Rajasthani cuisine and festive treats adds the authentic flavours of Rajasthan to the evening.

Experience Rajasthan in Melbourne

From colourful attire and folk traditions to music, food and family celebrations, Teej Utsav 2026 is a celebration for every generation of our RAJKOV Kutumb.

पधारो म्हारे Teej Utsav 2026!

Where Culture • Community • Celebrations Come Together

Event Highlights-Chaupal



Event Highlights- Chaupal

Chaupal Connect 2026 – A Day to Remember

RAJKOV's first Chaupal Connect 2026 brought together 80–100 members, including 6–7 new families, for an afternoon filled with culture, conversations, laughter and togetherness.
The Chaupal provided a wonderful platform for old friends to reconnect while warmly welcoming new families into our growing RAJKOV Kutumb.

Delicious Kachori, Mirchi Vada and Garam Chai added the authentic taste and warmth of a traditional Rajasthani gathering.

IInteractive games and activities brought all generations together, creating plenty of laughter and friendly competition.
The fun-filled Antakshari became one of the highlights of the afternoon, with everyone singing, participating and creating memorable moments together.

A heartfelt special thanks to our Committee Members and Volunteers for their planning, teamwork and dedication, and to Mallika for her additional support with the decorations.
Special appreciation to Dilip Ji and Preeti Ji for their contribution to the entertainment and Vishal Sharma Ji for beautifully capturing the day through photography and reels.

A special thanks to our Youth and Kids – Aarush, Avantika, Ira, Veer, Mallika and Prassidhi – for their enthusiastic participation, presentations and wonderful energy that made the gathering even more special.

Our sincere gratitude to all our Sponsors and Supporters whose generosity and continued trust help RAJKOV create meaningful cultural and community experiences.

Chaupal was truly about बैठक, बातचीत, अपनापन और साथ — bringing generations together and celebrating the true spirit of our RAJKOV Kutumb.








Audience is the judge: best Chaupal-theme sentences decid





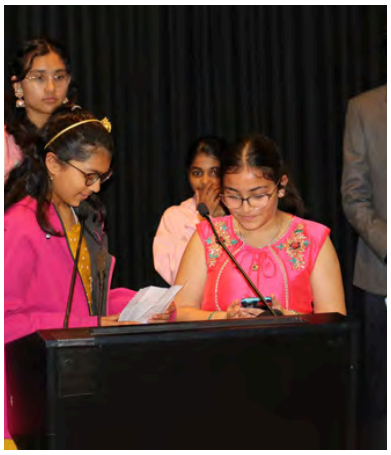

Rajkot
CHAUPAL CONNECT












Rajkot
CHAUPAL CONNECT
2026






Thank
You

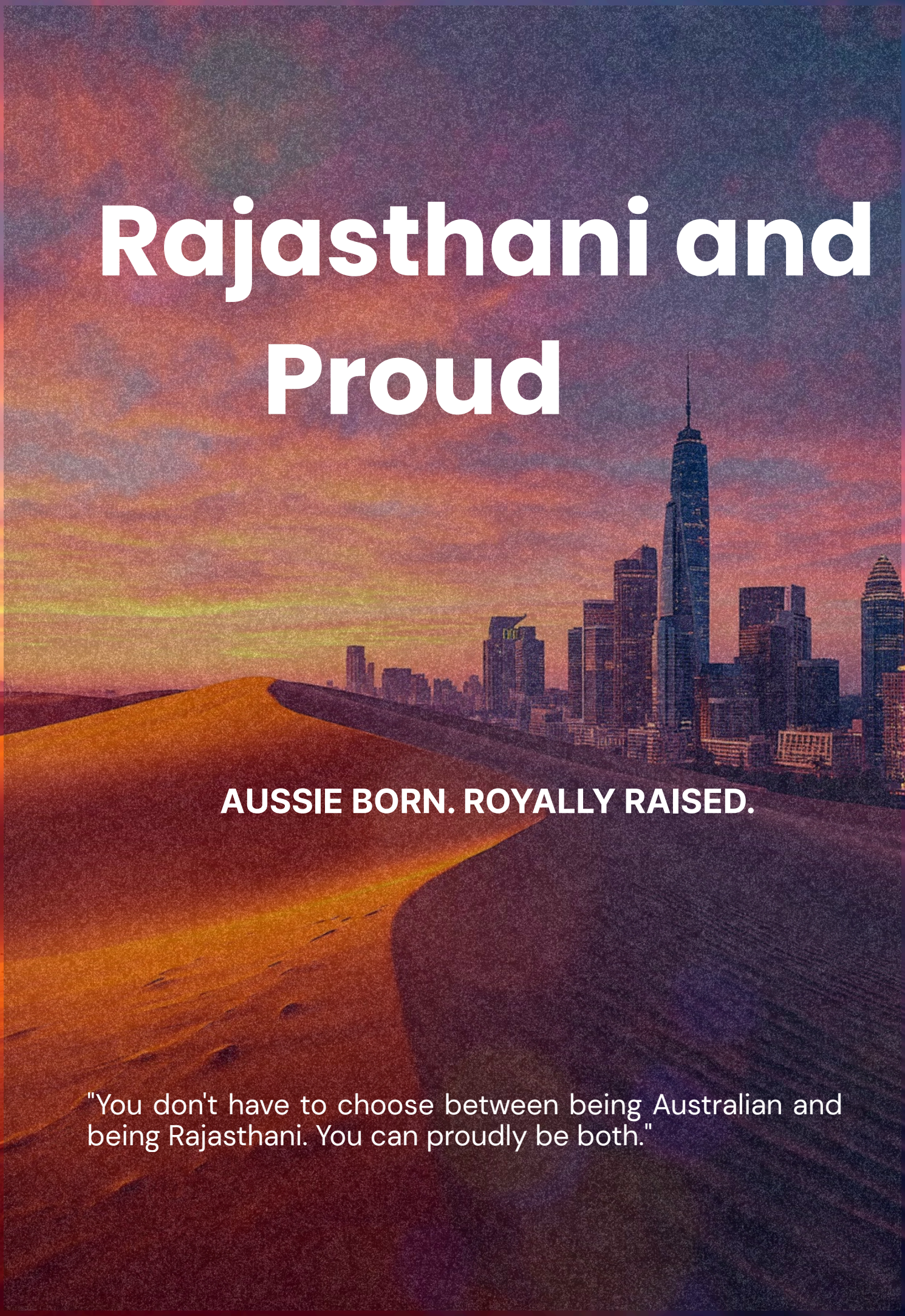







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Rajasthani and Proud



AUSSIE BORN. ROYALLY RAISED.

"You don't have to choose between being Australian and being Rajasthani. You can proudly be both."